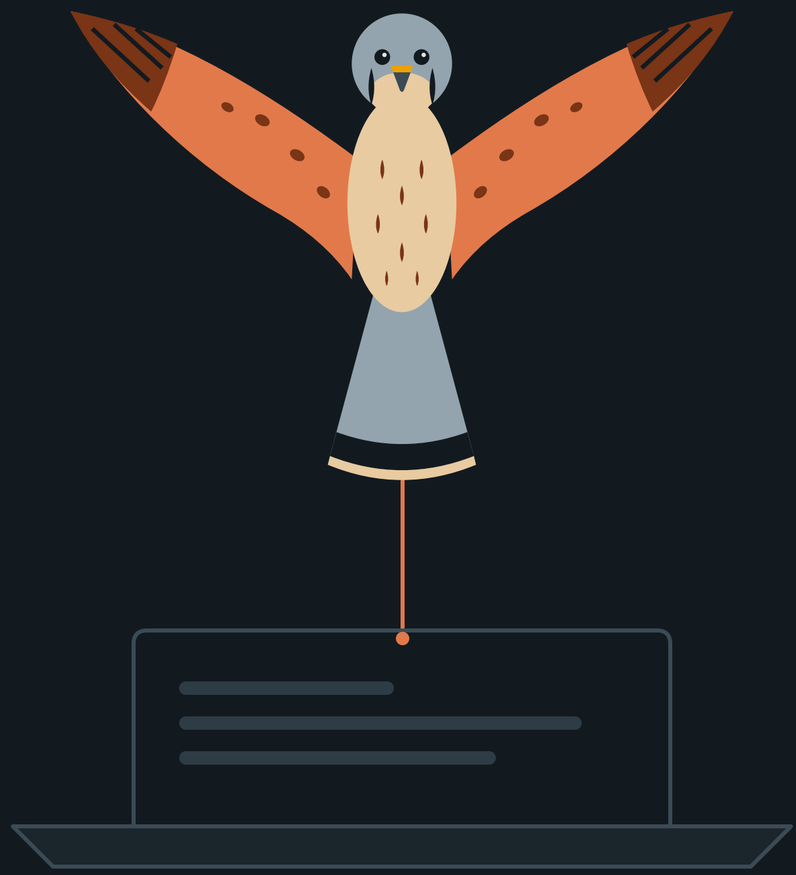
Kestrel

An assistant that lives on your laptop.
Nothing you type leaves it.

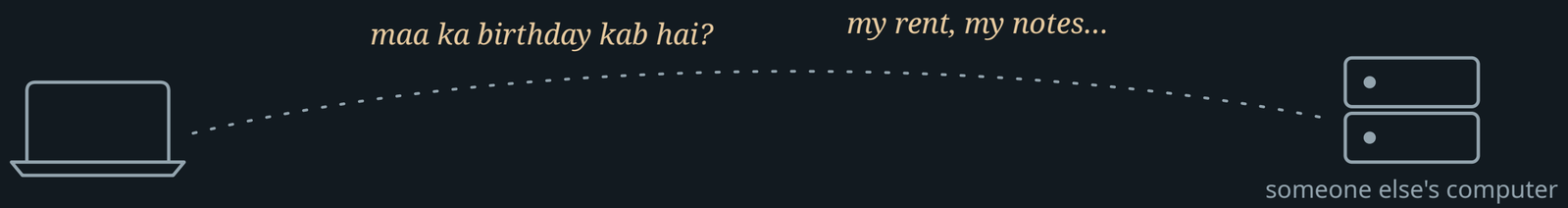


Version 3, October 2026

Most assistants send your words to someone else's computer.

Kestrel does the work on the laptop in front of you.

Usually



Kestrel



maa ka birthday kab hai?

The question, the notes and the answer stay on this laptop.

No internet needed

Works with the wifi off.

₹0 to use

No subscription and no paid service behind it.

Open models

Small language models that run on the laptop itself.

What you can ask it, in English or Hinglish

Tasks and reminders
remind me to call asha tomorrow at 5 pm

Answer questions from your notes
maa ka birthday kab hai?

Rewrite and translate
make this polite: send me the file now

Write and check small Python code
prime number check karne ka python function likho

Find notes by meaning
search my notes for maa ke liye tohfa

Write emails
manager ko friday ki chutti ke liye mail likh do

Chat and explain
sardi ki subah pe chaar lines likho

Says so when it can't
what's the weather in delhi today?

Real requests, real answers

kal shaam 6 baje bill bharna yaad dila dena

created task #2: bill bharna (due 2026-10-28 18:00)

answered in 4.8 s

maa ka birthday kab hai?

Maa ka birthday 20 September hai.
(from 2026-09-08-mom-birthday.md)

answered in 9.4 s

translate to hindi: good morning, see you tomorrow

सुप्रभात, कल मिलते हैं

answered in 2.8 s

goa wale hotel ka naam kya hai?

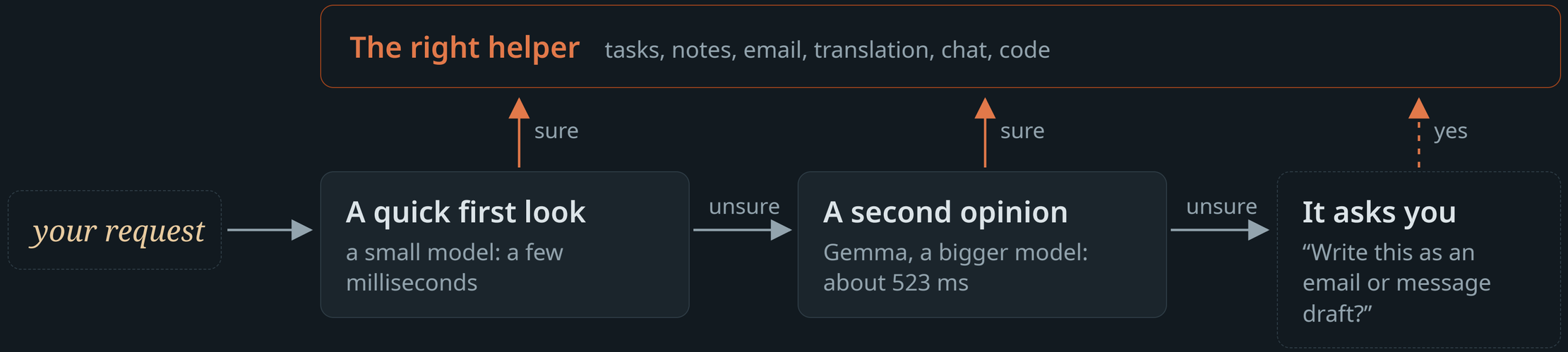
The notes do not say this: so the reply is not available for this information

answered in 3.0 s

Word for word from the last full test before version 3 was frozen, on a copy of Kestrel with sample notes, not anyone's real notes.

How it decides what you want

Like a good receptionist: a quick look, a second opinion, then a question.



256/280
decisions right on the test set

13
times it asked first

6
times it started something nobody asked for

280 test requests we wrote in English and Hinglish (24 new, the rest used once before). When both are unsure but the first look leans to Kestrel's everyday tools, it just uses them. Gemma's time is from the practice set.

It finds notes by what they mean

maa ke liye tohfa

“a gift for mom”: the note says “gift ideas”, never “tohfa”

2026-09-08-mom-birthday.md, found by meaning

Maa's birthday, 20 September

Gift ideas: a cotton saree in light blue, or the steel tiffin set she liked at the mall.

Order the eggless chocolate cake from the corner bakery two days before.

Hinglish searches found, practice set



Now it first turns a Hinglish search into English, then looks.

14/18 searches found the right note on the test set

When no note fits, it adds none: 0/2 wrong notes added on the test set.

It answers from your notes, or says they don't have it

on which date do i fly to goa?

> Flights are booked for the 14th, and you will be back on the 18th.

goa wale hotel ka naam kya hai?

> The notes do not say this: so the reply is not available for this information

Before it shows an answer, Kestrel checks that the numbers and names in it are in your note.

25/25

test questions handled right

Questions the notes answer: 19/19 right.
Questions they don't: 6/6 times it said so.
A small test of the answering step, on sample notes.
Spotting that a question is about your notes is a separate step: 12/16 on its test.

It writes small Python code, and checks it in a sealed box

fix this function: def add(a, b): return a - b

```
def add(a, b):
    return a + b
```

(I checked it in a safe sandbox: no errors.)



- No internet inside the box
- It can't see your files
- Limits on time and memory

On the test set

Functions	■■■■■■	6/6
Fixes	■■■■■■	6/6
Explanations	■■■■■■	6/6
Scripts	■■■□□□	3/6

21/24 requests passed our checks

Python's built-in tools only. The box loads the code to catch mistakes; it does not run your program with your own input. Explanations were checked for their key points only.

All of this runs on an ordinary laptop

Ryzen 5 5500U processor, 6 cores, **14.95 GiB** of memory, no separate graphics card.

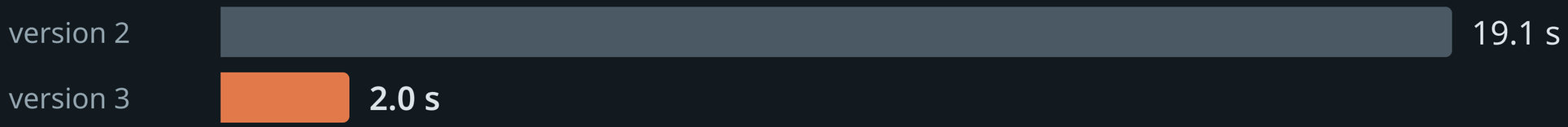
Memory the language model holds and can't give back

Version 3 maps the model file instead of copying it, so the laptop can take most of that memory back when it needs it.

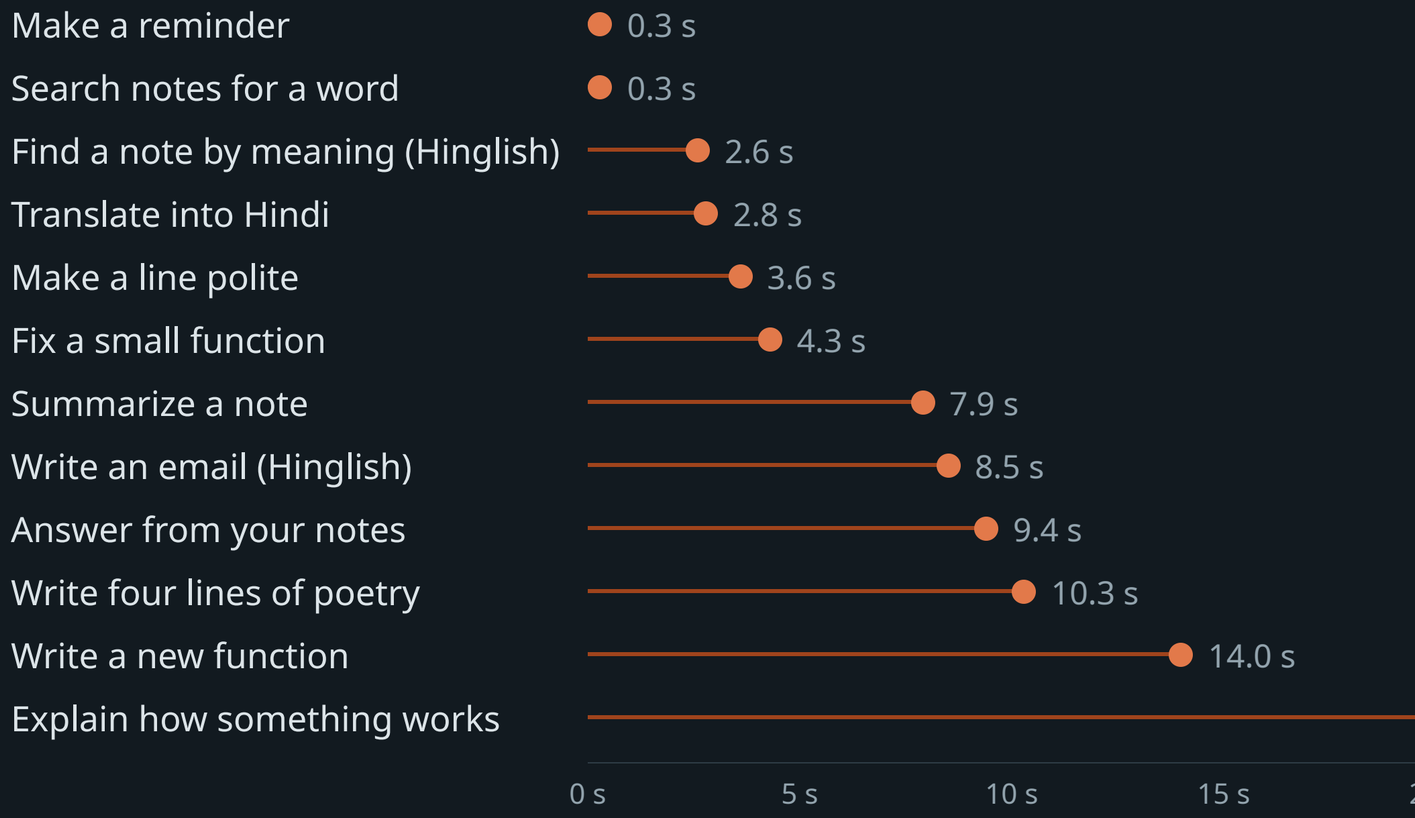


Time until the language model is ready

Version 3 saves its warm-up on the disk once, instead of redoing it every time it starts.



How long you wait



Under a second

for most of Kestrel's own tools; some Hinglish requests take seconds.

A few seconds or more

when the language model writes, because it writes word by word.

You start reading early

Written answers appear word by word; notes answers and summaries once checked.

Seconds until the whole answer, one test run each.

Tested like a real user, then frozen

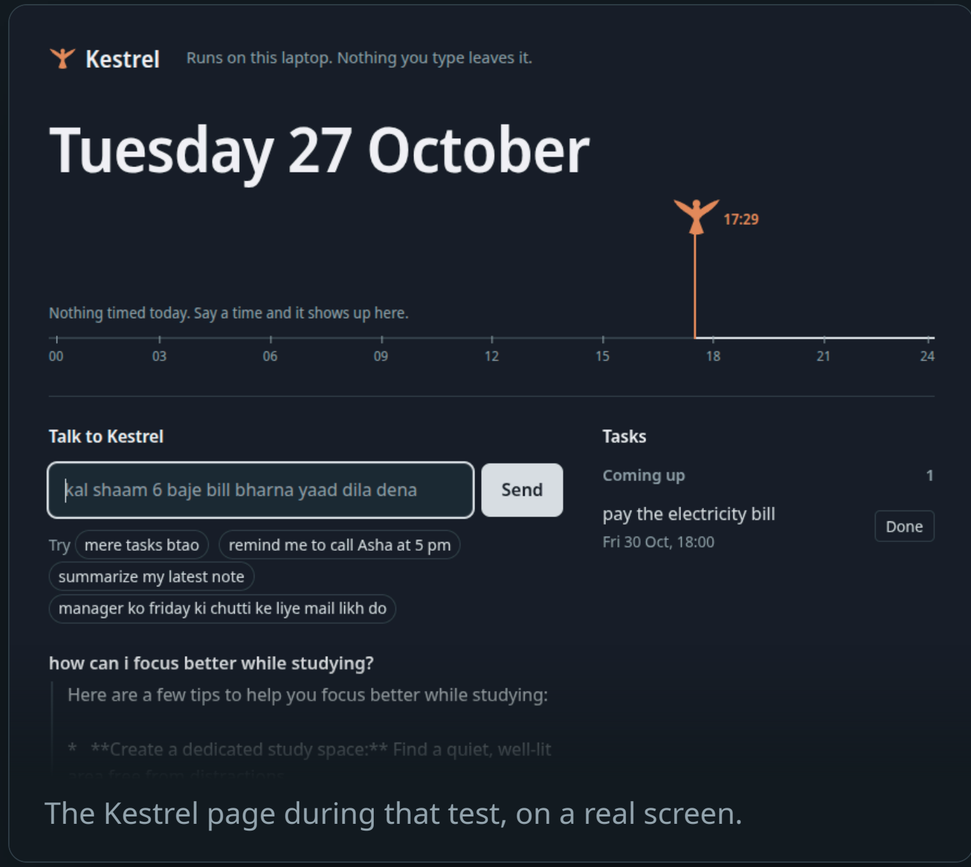
34/36

everyday requests passed end to end

The web page passed 8/8 checks in a hidden browser and 8/8 on a real screen.

A reminder set for 17:31 popped up at 17:31:02.

448 automatic checks of Kestrel's code passed, and **510** of the scripts that test it.



The Kestrel page during that test, on a real screen.

What it can't do well yet

The main ones; the full list written down at the freeze has 12.

Some questions about your notes are refused

how much is my rent? got “I can't do that”, though the rent is in the notes.

It doesn't remember the conversation

continue or a follow-up question does not see its last answer.

Formatting shows as symbols

Bold text and bullet points appear with their stars.

Programs that read what you type often fail

Scripts were right 3/6 times on the test set.

Some Hinglish questions get English answers

Notes answers came back in Hinglish 9/12 times on the practice set.

Small tests, written by us

Every test set was made for this project. Real people's requests come next.

What comes next

Version 3 is frozen. The next round starts from how people really use it.

Learn from real mistakes

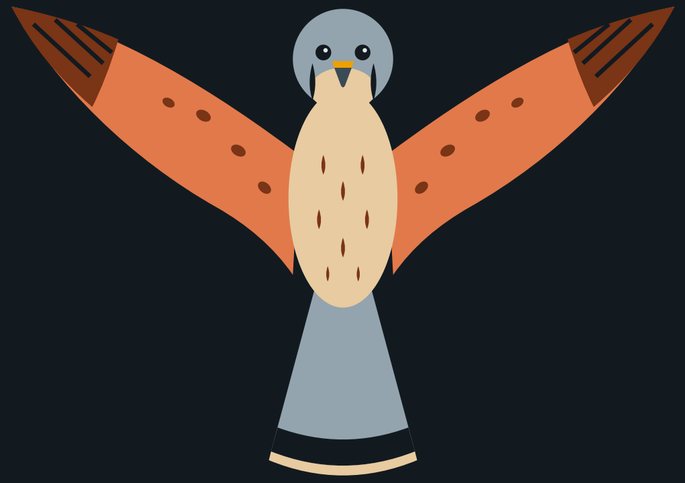
Collect the requests it gets wrong in daily use, teach it with them, and test again on questions it has never seen.

Close the gaps

Work through the list on the last slide, one at a time, each with its own test.

Version 4 on a bigger machine

Larger models on a Mac or a stronger computer, still offline, still private.



Your words stay on your laptop.

Thank you. Questions are welcome.